AI FOR MANAGERS · STUDY GUIDE

You Have a Picture. You Don't Have a Standard.

The baseline shows how differently people work with AI. What does the team now need to agree on, together?

MODULE 3 · LESSON 1 | ALIGN: BUILDING A SHARED WAY OF WORKING | Module opener · 3–4 min

THE CORE IDEA

A picture of AI use is not a standard for it.

Align turns individual variation into one shared agreement – and that agreement has to be set, not left to chance.

1 From seeing to agreeing

Assess gave you something you did not have before: a clear picture of how AI is already shaping your team's work – your **Team AI Baseline**. That picture keeps paying off through the rest of the course. But some of what it surfaces needs a team-level answer now. That is where **Align** – the second move of the framework – begins. Align turns the picture into a shared standard, and your job changes with it: from seeing what is happening to agreeing how your team will work.

2 A picture isn't a standard

Look again at what the baseline shows. People use different tools, review AI-assisted work differently, and make different assumptions about what information is acceptable to put in. Seeing those differences is not the same as settling them.

Not every difference should disappear – people do different work and should keep their **professional judgment**. But the matters that affect everyone need one shared answer: which tools and data are acceptable, what has to be reviewed, and when AI use should be visible. Picture one recurring task – the same weekly update – produced three different ways by three people, one of them through a personal AI account. The variation is visible; a shared answer to any of it is not.

So what the baseline reveals is not a set of individual problems to fix one conversation at a time. It is **one missing team standard** – and it has to be agreed once, together.

3 What Align builds

TERM – TEAM WORKING STANDARD

The output of Align: a shared agreement on how AI is used in the team – the Five Agreements (Tools, Data, Review, Disclosure, and Direction and Support) plus descriptions of important recurring workflows.

Align's job across this module is to turn scattered differences into that one standard: a short, explicit agreement on the things that affect everyone. By the end of Align, the standard is what you walk away with.

4 The path through the module

The module builds it across four lessons. **First**, why setting the standard has to be your call at all – because leaving AI use to each person no longer holds. **Then** two build lessons: Layer 1, the five agreements every team needs; and Layer 2, how AI fits the actual recurring work your team does together. **Finally**, putting the standard into practice – so it becomes how people work, not a document nobody reads.

That path asks something new of you: not making every AI call for your people, but setting up the frame they work within.

> WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY AFTER THIS LESSON
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> - Treat the Team AI Baseline as a **starting point, not a result** – differences seen are not differences settled.
> - Separate the two kinds of decisions: professional judgment in the work stays individual; matters that affect everyone need **one shared answer**.
> - Aim for one standard agreed once, with the whole team – not a series of one-to-one fixes.
> - Expect the frame-setting to be yours: the standard has to be **set, not left to chance**.

Module 3 · Align: Building a Shared Way of Working – this module turns the picture from Assess into one shared Team Working Standard. **Next: Lesson 3.2 – Why "Use AI If You Want" No Longer Works** – why setting this standard has to be the manager's call at all.